

ActInf Textbook Group ~ Cohort 1 ~ Meeting 1 (Onboarding)

TextbookGroup/ParrPezzuloFriston2022/Cohort_1 | Cohort 1 ~ Meeting 1 (Onboarding) | 55:43

hello everyone thank you for joining
this is the
recorded and live onboarding session for
the first cohort of
the active inference textbook group
and this
session is going to cover
many of the sections of our coda and
hopefully resolve your uncertainty about
participating in different aspects of
the textbook group
so there will be some presentations but
also a ton of time for questions so feel
free to use the chat
box on the bottom right hand side
to add any questions
um hello welcome
feel free to use the chat box on the
bottom right side to add any questions
and also feel free to raise your hands
and then we'll be able to see that hand
raised if you'd like to ask your
question but also it could be really
helpful just to add it in the chat
during this presentation so
you can click on the screen
that's being shared to see
it zoomed in
and so
you should be able to see my info screen
and some clicks
all right
so
welcome everybody to the actin flap
whether it's your first time

participating in

actin flab or in anything related to

active inference

welcome hope that this is like

a space where we can really

have some amazing things happen

this coda

that we're all looking at and that we

all have access to is our shared

epistemic niche and so you can of course

have your own notes and own documents

but this is our shared collaborative

niche

we are working through the textbook and

learning active inference this recent

textbook by par pizzulo in fristen

and by right clicking you can download

the pdf

full or the one where the pdf pages and

the book pages are aligned

just in case you wanted to download it

and it's also awesome that it's an open

source textbook

if you ever have any questions about

anything related to participating in

the textbook group or in any aspect of

actin flab then

activeinference@gmail.com a good email

address to contact

okay

so i'm gonna in the sidebar go to this

second one rules and also this sidebar

can be shown or hidden with the two

arrows so first we'll go over some of

the rules

and also with the understanding that

this is an evolving

area

and it's our first cohort so just
super appreciative and it's really
awesome for those for many different
places and stages who have stepped up to
engage in this way

and

we stipulate that by engaging with this
coda and in the live meetings so not in
private conversations not in your own
private documents but within the shared
spaces that are synchronous and
asynchronous that we're creating
together

we're in a participatory open science
space

and that means that

no proprietary or inappropriate
information will be shared

and that

more positively any ideas and writing
and contributions that are shared in
this shared coda

or during these recorded

sessions that we'll have

these are understood to be

declared as creative commons ccby
attribution so state otherwise or don't

say it if it's different because that's

how it's going to be understood in the
comments

and then of course if somebody's like

interested in this area of attribution

and all of this in in online spaces in

participatory communities that's an

important area

during the course of the textbook group

we are students

so we're interacting here as individuals

on the path of learning and applying so
some of us might be interested in
research as well and there will be
hopefully a ton of time to connect and
find those collaborations but we're
going to keep the regime of attention
on the learning the familiarity
accessibility and competency of active
inference as it is in that textbook that
doesn't mean it's going to be the only
document that we look at other resources
are going to come into play but it's
about learning
not research and we're interested in
this textbook that's what's bringing us
together
and
please be an engaged learner however
that means for you so whether you're
checking in once in a while
and just asking some questions here and
there
adding a comment like by selecting text
and then on the right side hitting the
add comment
whatever that kind of participation
looks for you or maybe you're
interested in re-skilling and in three
months you'd like to be in a totally
different position and you're
approaching this in a multiple hours per
day way we just hope that your
participation is open and authentic and
again if you have any questions about it
you can email
the next page we'll look at is the
directory so the directory has links
to the different sections of the coda

and anytime you see like a blue link with an emoji next to it that's something you can click on and go to that page so this has just descriptions on what the different pages are and it's what the onboarding is and it's also this like an asynchronous onboarding page if something's unclear again you could just say i'm not really sure about this what does it mean to do dot dot dot okay so that's kind of the preliminaries is just welcoming those who are new and returning to actin flab stating some of the rules and bases for our shared experience and then just describing the structure of this coda the next thing that we're going to talk about is the onboarding and feel free during this or any time to to add those questions into the chat okay so here in the onboarding section as a participant you have total access to the coda and the knowledge base here which we're going to be exploring in this session and so we suggest that especially for those who are new to coda they may want to watch this playlist that covers some of the basics of coda and there's also people to ask if you have any questions but it's something like a cloud document and a wiki because we do have a version history

although it's also easy to make edits
and you'll find that some pages are
locked like this page cannot be directly
edited in the text by a participant
however they're able to modify these as
many many have already done
so

um we're going to talk about like the
student workspace and student practices
and things like that
and then to

help this sort of
self onboarding that everyone can go
through

we have several things that you can do
and engage with right now
so first what you can do is add your
name into the onboarding checklist table
below and fill up the relevant
checklists

so this is referencing another
table which is the list of students so
these are just the people who have
rsvp'd and then

people have selected and we can add new
rows people have selected from this drop
down or by typing their name
they can select

and then can add check boxes
when they have completed different
stages of this onboarding so here's just

a few things that people can do
you can have the physical textbook which
is pretty cool also it's the free
download like we discussed on this top
page

you may want to plan the time in your
own calendar for when and how you're

going to work

even if you don't know what the details
are we're going to talk a lot about
practices but you might just want to say
okay doing two hours in this block on
this day or i'm going to try to come to
this weekly session time

people are also welcome to add links to
their own personal or active blog
platform this is an affordance that not
everyone is required to engage in
nothing is mandated it's totally just a
service and an experience that we're
co-creating in this first cohort but you
may want to

have some short or medium or long
writings

about your reflections and about your
learnings so you may want to add this
blog and it's cool some have already
done that

and then

we offer

this student workspace and the student
workspace you can click on that link and
you head over to here

and there's a link that allows you to
open a new coda template

and use this template and so that copies
this to your code account so

the template was created by activelab
however

it is not going to be like viewable or
anything so this is not

something part of the textbook group
shared cohort um coda this is just going
to provide some tables and some
templates for you to play around but

also be potentially
tracking your progress in various ways
next we're going to go to the student
practices but
would alex or yvonne or anyone like to
just mention anything about onboarding
or the student workspaces
yeah i can give quick review on it
just
could you could you
open
the list
here
uh what practice is
uh
this one this one
student practice is okay it's okay also
yeah
here is the table that
help you to
track your
trick your study
so
we understand that the textbook is
not
not easy to read and not easy to
find time to
have a study on it
so this practices
will help you to keep your attention
during the whole
free
months
when we will
study it
so
we have
a

small description on each

on each

practice and

you can even understand

what they are

by its

name

[Music]

go through it and if you will have some

questions

just let us know

thanks um

that takes us perfectly to this student

practices which is kind of the question

of okay we set the groundwork

we onboarded ourselves onto

the textbook group using these

checkboxes

and now we're ready to like participate

and to engage with the content which is

going to be almost entirely asynchronous

we will have some live sessions like at

this time or potentially at other times

that others scaffold however it's going

to be about the learners engagement on

their own terms and times with the

content and so that is where

drawing on some practices from other

areas

we have constructed this table of

student practices

so it's kind of like a grab bag or a

tool kit where people can

find some affordance for their

participation so if you ever find

yourself

uncertain on how to participate in the

textbook group or uncertain on how to

increase your familiarity or your
competency in active inference
these are practices
that you can reach for
and you can add comments and also we can
absolutely add
to the practices we can add rows we can
add descriptions and products
but these are some regimes of attention
some tasks you can engage in
which
will help you
become more familiar with the material
and so there is this practice of like
thinking by speaking in dialogue joining
the synchronous meetings or arranging
meetings of your own type
and then a lot of the other learning
practices are going to be
asynchronous
alex or anyone else would you like to
ask anything okay and yes i just fixed
the permissioning on the template so now
it should be possible for people to copy
the template over
and then just one other random coda tip
if you do control and scroll
or control and plus minus
that can make the text bigger or smaller
so that can be quite helpful sometimes
okay so alex or anyone else um
any thoughts on practices
uh yeah let me add something on these
practices um
we are organizing this textbook group
trying to provide
some kind of
new affordances

to learning path
which will be more effective
if you're not just reading
the textbook by your own
but also communicate
inside this
shared epistemic niche from one hand
and from another hand
based on
our work on in education
on some of our projects we understand
that if you systematically applied some
learning practices
and tracking your progress
possibly day by day or week by week
with tools that also provided
in the template uh
you just from the beginning it's good
looks like some but some easy
stuff
but basically
after applying these practices for a few
weeks
you can figure out how it's really could
be helpful for you
we understand that
here different people with different
background different expertise
but for study groups let's just be
students again
and just apply these practices and it
will bring us
[Music]
more results that we even can expect it
for now
thanks
thank you alex
so um

we're gonna explore a little bit deeper
into the practices and then we'll talk
more about this
core
shared epistemic aspect of our coda
because of course if people wanted to
work alone
and not have any synchronous exchanges
with people and not have any shared
epistemic niche
they could do that on their own but
we're doing something with the textbook
group in the acting lab that's
collaborative and participatory
so as
seen in the
template but also on this page mastering
students
practices the practices are there to
help
keep our attention as learners
on
the material
through focusing on the practices
and so people can add their own columns
and explore but these are the kinds of
things where if somebody
could have high systematicity in
developing them
like approaching them in a very
systematic and comprehensive way
they would be learning and applying
active inference as works for them so
that's kind of a cool
way to have a self-paced and flexible
educational experience
and these are also just the pages that
are in that student workspace so it'll

be cool to see how these practices
develop
and
any comments or questions that people
have on them
does anyone want to raise their hand or
ask a question in the chat
the template is not working for people
right now
so
um
so i think are there two templates
there's like the checklist template and
then there's the student workspace
template i'm not getting the student
workspace one to work
as i see it doesn't work
when you
have a preview but
once you
push the button use template
it
became available for you
as anyone
where's the use template button
so
um what one thing also is people could
just
create a new code a document and then
just
copy
just ctrl c and copy it into a new
page so that will always work and the
template is not
vast
it's just these several tables so we'll
try to figure out the permissions
um

[Music]

okay

all right and also so i'm going to

unfold

some of these areas that we've spoken

about

and continue on with some of the

core epistemic components

of our coda and again anyone can raise

their hand

or can

add a comment in the chat yes rohan if

you would like to

ask your question

uh yeah so i'm not able to make copies

of this

template i'm so produce uh short once

again if you don't live

um okay so

um are you able to do to click these

three dots

and then do

copy to doc

and then copy it to a new doc

sorry that doesn't show up for me i'm

not okay

okay so then the it may just be because

like

i'm in the account that created it so

anyone can create a new coda document

like by clicking this back arrow

and then just creating a new document

and not kind of on that type of home

page

and then just

copy like you can just

go into this page and select the

content and copy it

and then just paste it into your coda

um

and we'll try to figure out the template

blue

so it did work for me if you on the

student workspace like the um red wheel

one

okay so not the orange one but the red

wheel if you click on the three dots

that are next to the workspace in the

sidebar there you go and click that and

then copy to doc that worked for me

it still may well it depends on what

somebody's access may be with um active

documents but

um copying will always work real hon did

that resolve it

uh okay so

i did that i could find the copy to dock

uh it made something not entirely sure

where it is now so so copy the dock and

then like we'll copy it to a new dock

and then oh okay and then now that's

totally your document so it's not part

of the action fork space at all

okay so i have to go back and then

search for it

yes it becomes so within the shared

epistemic niche within our shared coda

it's all like subpages in one url but

then once you copy it to your own doc

from a template or however it's going to

be your own url with your own sharing

privileges it's totally owned by you

okay yeah well i found it anyway yeah so

the copyright yeah great

okay so

can raise their hand if they want or ask

a question otherwise we'll continue on
to talk about um the ways in which we're
going to structure this collaborative
discourse on the material

so this discourse section has a few sub
headings

we have a page for ideas of the book
and so also if anything is ever like
unable to be edited

then just like but you feel like it
should be then just let us know because
we tried to permission things
to minimize the ability of someone to
accidentally like delete informative
text

and as much as possible we'll structure
things in tables

which should be editable so in the ideas
of the book these are like memes and
themes

what is active inference like when we
want to convey that to ourself and to
others those are the ideas

in chapter one this is an idea
and then there can be discourse on that
and these

buttons open up a canvas and you can
write things in there

we have um

questions this is a really important and
uh gonna be hopefully a very fascinating
and productive page

one coda affordance that's very
fun is at

is like calling a variable and that
could be anything from a person to the
name of a page a table or even a row in
a table

and so
the questions
can be
written in plain text but then also
people may enrich them
in this way and so we're going to return
to this question but first i just want
to show what equation 2.1
is
where is it coming from
so here in the equations section we have
another table with all the equations
right now just equation 2.1 has been
added
what is the name of the equation
what is the picture of the equation
screenshot
what page what chapter and what are some
tags which we'll talk about soon too
but
this is something that one person has to
add one time
then go back to questions
when
something is blue with an $\mathbb{A}$ at you can
mouse over it or you can click on it
so then
how is equation 2.1 related to markup
blanket
is something that's very accessible
it's interactive we can have it
translated into multiple languages like
the terms we've already translated as a
lab into seven languages and especially
if people have a language that they'd
like to improve or add this can just be
added and so these kinds of
questions that we all raise up so

whether or not you do this like
ultracoda version or you just want to
write it in plain text and have somebody
else improve it
this is going to be able to create
computationally accessible
representations of questions that are
very clear
and also answers that are very clear and
there can be multiple answers in a lot
of discourse
but then those are addressing what
are
some answers to that question that like
a person may have
and
again uh
it's awesome if a question instead of
like
coming from an ill-specified
pointer and a
unclear regime of attention of course we
have uncertainty that's what the
question is representing but also we can
ask it in a way where even if we totally
don't know
what i don't know what equation 2.1 is
showing
i don't know what the markov blanket is
but by asking it in this way there's
like a conversation to have and people
can upvote interesting questions
and then again
we'll add the figures
as rows in the figures
the equations
here so then someone can say how does
figure 1.1 relate to action what was

figure 1.1 ah okay how does figure 1.1
relate to
ok action
those are just some of the ways in which
we'll be able to
have this
really
special
interactive space so that was that
questions page where we'll just be
building tons and tons of questions
and whether you write them initially in
your own private workspace or you want
to write them here
another important aspect of the
questions
is that the textbook doesn't have any
exercises or questions of any kind
and so this is like
in this first cohort and in this
textbook group
in general we're
in a sense creating some questions and
clarifying
adventures around
this textbook itself
as learners so that's the questions page
in the live meetings
page
we write that all are encouraged to join
these live meetings
or watch their video recordings where
we're going to be going over the ideas
of the book and the questions
the timings are noted here
of this
weekly time slot and what the theme or
the regime of attention is going to be

and also you've been added to a calendar
using the email you signed up for or you
can add these links in
and then if
somebody wants to
propose a one-off time or a recurrent
time
where they want to co-work
or they want to do these sessions they
absolutely can do that and we can update
the textbook group calendar here
the video recordings will be posted
to these links afterwards
and in this first meeting we're having
the onboarding session now
this is going to set
a
pace for moving through the first five
chapters of this textbook over the next
three months
and there's plenty
to dig into and plenty of rabbit holes
to explore
and so some might go
read ahead or
be behind you know life happens and
we're accommodating of that but this is
gonna set
a rhythm and a pace
where we'll be able to go okay we're
gonna talk about chapter one so what are
we going to do we're going to go to the
ideas of the book and the questions
we're going to look at what are some
ideas in chapter one
what are some questions that are tagged
with
specific references in chapter one and

what has been upvoted if there's too many to discuss and then that is gonna be the structuring of the regime of attention so it would be super helpful if somebody especially wants to like be speaking and asking questions about it the material to put in the time before to add those so that people can parse it and really consider your question and your ideas beforehand because there's differences in our language and our familiarity with active inference so sometimes the spontaneous rant is difficult for others to parse and structuring our questions and writing the ideas down and helping improve how each other's have shared it will be a really important shared practice and then we can have people in the live meetings taking notes on the questions and so then if somebody does have a spontaneous thought arising in relationship to a question or some discourse on an idea we can absolutely record it and make that something that persists rather than just uh a sort of offhand comment in a video chat so those are the live meetings and the calendar and we're in gather right now and so there's some information on if you'd like to for

example enable

various features of gather

including adding live text captioning to
your video if that's like something
you're interested in

but this is just a little bit of a
technical note on how to use gather and
some of the affordances of gather
okay

i cannot find the raise your hand button

i have not used it on an ipad

um but

on the bottom there's a hand
that raises your hand and also it stays
raised unless you unraise it and then

it's also there in the emoji

and all the emojis are transient

except for when you hit um the hand or
when you hit just six

from your computer then that raises your
hand

but um ali if you want to ask a question

then please feel free but first um okay

rohan then yvonne

oh no i was just testing

six thing

sorry great okay seems like you were too

yvonne so great

okay

so

we have project ideas

so here was a suggestion by a
participant

so

as with

many suggestions

this is our editable space we're the
first cohort of the textbook group so

however we want to do this

we can do it

feel free to list any project ideas here

so this is a fully editable page people

can just add

wouldn't it be cool like if there was an

audiobook recording i don't know

maybe that's something that somebody

else will see as a very exciting

opportunity so you can add different

project ideas and then

we've provided a template for some

tables that you can copy out

that are kind of like questions that

will help provide some overview

information

on your project optional of course just

like everything or add columns add rows

delete it's all up to you

and

questions that are about the situation

that you're seeing that is motivating

that kind of a project idea

and help you get some initial

structuring around like how you would go

about doing that

and this will get your idea from the

sort of

format here into something maybe that

other people could get on board with

so that's in the discourse um because

these are like really

content

and perspectives that

as a textbook group we're going to be

adding and creating

in this textbook section

it's going to be really focused on the

textbook as that core artifact so as
mentioned before there's the special
pages and tables
with the figures equations and the boxes
so then oh yes

at

box space 2.1

enter

at box 2.1 oh okay

there it is

and then people can have any questions
or comments and so on and then that
could be referenced in a question
somewhere else

what does at box space 2.1

mean for

um there's also these chapters and so
the chapters

are

listed here and linked so you can click
on five and go to chapter five

there's also a detailed table of
contents which

may have been created by dave or he
found it but he sent it to us and this

is like a really

fine-grained

look at the sections of the book

and whichever column in a table

as this ribbon

is the one that's called the display
column

so you can have like a set as display
column

and so that means like

um i was reading at 1.4.2

and this happens

it's page 11.

so every row
and all of its associated columns
can be referenced anywhere within this
coda you won't be able to reference
these rows in another coda
but this is like our shared commons of
information where we're able to enrich
the rows and create rows for each other
and that will hopefully create kind of
like a snowball effect with our digital
stigma g
because people will be able to ask
amazing
well supported questions
and then those questions themselves
when
blue
asked
how is equation 2.1 related to this
here's what it made me think of so
there's like a structuring
to the way in which we can use certain
pieces of information and so again we
have the textbook section with the
chapters
and like we're starting on chapter one
and these are a lot of concepts and area
where people can explore
now you'll see that a lot of terms
have this at and they're blue so let's
look at where that is coming from and
that takes us to the last section of our
coda and then we'll spend the last 15
minutes with just
discussion and questions
the um
somebody has asked does coda allow text
to be formatted with latex thank you

brock for sharing the link
and um
yes if people would like that that's
something we can absolutely do
additionally we could um have a column
here
insert column after
and this can just be the latex
representation for example
so then you can copy and paste that to
allow people to modify it or to use it
in another work
okay so where are these core terms
coming from
in active inference tables we have a few
different tables
that are
prepared and created also in a
collaborative way
in other projects of the actin flap
so those who are participating in the
lab may know about some of these
projects but for those of you who might
be joining the first active lab
activity right now here's what these are
about
so active inference ontology
you can go to this link
and see the public version of the actin
phontology so this is like a link you
can share with anyone
and it has two pages there's the
definitions
of
core terms
which we'll return to and then there's
the translations
so here we have

i'll edit and resolve this but for core terms

we have spanish portuguese french italian czech russian and hebrew so if there's a language that somebody has some familiarity with even if you only know some of it

it would be super helpful

to start to work in the dot edu

organizational unit of active lab on this ontology project because we're really

focused on making this accessible to those with different mathematical backgrounds and also different speaking of different languages so it's an awesome way even if you don't know that much active inference to translate some terms

and potentially bridge into a totally new area

those tables

are in

our coda here so there's like another coda that's holding the actual um ontology and then this is a cross document poll which we can like sync and so that's one of the really important and powerful features of coda so each of these terms

can be called using an at so at action space

planning

and then clicking that

enables the definition to pop up and there's a ton of other columns but we just wanted to pull a simple version so the ontology

page

is hosting the table

that is giving the definitions of

different ontology terms

and also there's the public site

the live stream

table

has many many papers

some may be familiar or not that we've

done

150 plus live streams

the

live streams in the round table section

have to do with active lab updates and

strategy

in the live stream section

these are

on papers and so you'll find 46 papers

that we've been discussing over the last

however many months

and these are like great if you want to

dive into any of the papers that are

listed here

the guests stream

are

visiting

presentations and discussions

that

different individuals in the sort of

active or adjacent areas are presenting

on so if anybody has like a

recommendation or a connection or would

like to present on a guest stream these

are scheduled on a more ad hoc basis but

they have tons of awesome

uh

areas and applications

model stream is more specifically about

modeling

and um one of particular note is this four part series with christopher white and ryan smith on the step-by-step active inference guide which is like a paper that is very very similar to the textbook it's not exactly the same of course but it also walks through a lot of the things that the textbook walks through

um then an org stream is about organization and so we have also some other formats that haven't been used too much and we have this um symposium that we did with carl fristen last year so this live streams table is just if you feel like listening or watching some live streams on any number of a ton of different topics related to active inference that we've done as a lab and these are ones that you can participate in like if you want to talk about some of these papers you can join a live stream

then there's this active inference research

tab which is just sort of a partial view but it's been work with blue and our colleague rj

where we're working to be able to reference papers

in a very rich and interactive way inside and outside of coda so you'll find the abstracts and some information on several hundred active inference papers

in case you're looking for it

but there's also a lot more to this so

if you're interested in knowledge engineering and in curating active inference research and annotating research and these types of tasks then this is like a awesome area that takes us through the sections of the coda so just to recap info contains some information on pre-onboarding with the rules and directory and then the onboarding itself which everybody is welcomed to carry out for themselves student workspace provides some templates and ideas which you can elaborate on and so on but some ways that you can stay on top of carrying out the student practices and so anytime you're uncertain about what actions to engage in to reduce your uncertainty about learning and applying active inference these are always things that you can do in the discourse that's going to host some of the material and the discussions that we're having synchronously and asynchronously around the book about the ideas in the book and the questions that are raising up and also hosting some project ideas that people are rising up or seeing as potentially relevant then the textbook itself is going to host um [Music] unpacking and connections of the content in the chapters and also with a special focus on this annotation of the figures equations boxes and so on

that will allow the rest of the coda to
be like referencing the book
very clearly
and then there's the active inference
tables which are just showing off a few
of the coda features and a few of the
other projects in active lab and
so
that will be
at least the initial conditions of
our
coda and it'll probably evolve a lot in
the coming three months
so
that concludes the more presentation
aspects
of this onboarding session
for the next 15 minutes
anyone can type a question into the chat
or can raise their hands and we'll
hear from them
and then what's coming up next
is
over the next week we'll be
reading chapter one
engaging with the practices as they
relate
to
chapter one planning to read chapter one
investing time in reading chapter one
writing notes
adding a little blog post
asking questions about chapter one
talking to your
friends or family or active colleagues
about chapter one working with the
formalisms in chapter one
if people would like to there's a

totally optional link here

that they can use a hypothesis

annotation of the pdf so just it's there

if people want to but as with all these

practices they're totally optional and

this is like an off-site thing

um

and then

we'll continue on

so

that is um

yes okay roland asks

thanks for coordinating this are the

authors going to be participating at all

so we're in contact with the authors and

i won't speak for them into their

degree of participation in the future

which is unknown but they're excited and

hopefully happy

that

we're engaging in this way and we are in

contact with them but if there's some

other piece of information we can

provide sure

also they'll be watching the recorded

videos at least one of the authors

so yes

yes some of them may view some recorded

videos and they have access to the coda

and it would be awesome

for example

to have questions that we don't know the

answer to

maybe they do know the answer but also

maybe they don't and maybe there's

somebody here who does or there's

another author

who we can contact

um the textbook is a
a summary and a distillation and a tip
of the iceberg of a lot of ongoing
research
and so
asking those questions and then also in
the active lab we have
um relationships and ways of engaging
with many authors and relevant people
hopefully
so
we could
make it happen if it's important to make
it happen
ron or anyone else with a question
in the chat or
with their hand what is something that
people are just
excited or
motivated motivated about
what do they do
daniel did you not hear rohan no i it
says connecting for me sorry about that
oh yeah so rohan just asked a question
um maybe i think um he might need to
reload but
his question was will there be any code
involved at all what is the preferred
like platform for writing code or is it
just math
thanks
so
appendix c uh yeah i'm sorry about that
sometimes this does happen like as the
recording will show um you're just
connecting and so in those cases where
it seems like two people in gather like
are having a misconnection like one or

both people can reload and it usually
fixes it so sorry about that um
in the code section there's going to be
a few ways to engage with the code
one thing is that appendix c
is an annotated matlab
um code
so especially um in the older work
related to
spm statistical parametric mapping and
some of the earlier active inference
work matlab was the primary language
that was utilized
more recently there's been developments
in python and in julia
yes absolutely so pi mdp does offer code
so that's in python
and then another area of code that some
may be interested in developing in is
active block forms which is also
in python and was
initiated by jacob
and active block friends is implementing
active inference entities and
environments in cad cad which is a
complex systems design suite so that's
in python there's also julia
and some active inference methods in
julia
that are created by the bias lab
and
we also have created this repository
in github
for the textbook itself
so if anybody comments on this and just
says add me here's my github username
right here we'll add them to that
repository so if people want to do their

own code adventure of course great make
it happen um if people want to work in a
shop in a shared
code repository space
we'll have this
if people want to do any adventures in
python and julia and pi mdp and active
block brands and forney lab and all
these other amazing affordances they're
absolutely welcome to
we'll just remember that we're learning
the content of the textbook in the
textbook group and those are amazing
research and application avenues that
are super important and it's exactly
what learning active inference gets us
to the position of being able to engage
with
um
and i think
there's
as we'll maybe uncover um reasons why
the book is written primarily in natural
language
and figures and equations
it could have been a
notebook but it wasn't
so yes hopefully for those who are
computationally inclined
we'll have some code available
and also um again people can
raise their hand or ask a question but
um this is what the ontology
as we develop it and it's already far
more developed than this but if people
want to get involved here
one of the aims
is to have integrity across different

representations
of different human natural languages
different computational languages and
the formalisms in the analytical nature
of some of the core
of active inference
and so we can in the equations have tags
so
that will help us use ontology tags
to connect equations to
scripts
that are out there
using those same terms and so there can
be like a short blog article in another
language you don't speak
and a script in a computer language you
don't understand and a figure that you
didn't make but we can connect that
and generate and comprehend it in a way
that
may not have been done in other fields
or at other times so those are some of
the really exciting ways that we can
combine our perspective and our regimes
of attention
with appropriate collaboration so that
we can actually
learn and apply active inference better
because again if people just wanted to
listen to the
fristen lectures on youtube and read the
book alone
they absolutely can but to be engaged in
the textbook group is to be doing
something that's collaborative so hope
that addresses it
and
if anybody else wants to

raise their hand or ask a question in
the chat there's still time to do so
yeah in in the chat though what what do
people
expect and prefer
what would be epistemically valuable for
you
what would be pragmatically valuable for
you
on the top right you can switch from
light to dark
in the coda
just in case it looks very different for
you
so yeah this onboarding session
could have been about any topic
although we were looking at active
inference related themes and we're
setting up of course for the textbook
group we
didn't discuss any of the material
but that's exactly what is going to be
happening
in the actual weeks to come
so
if anyone has like any
kind of
notes they'd like to add in
for the people who are here and for the
people who may be re-watching this
recording
feel free to add anything again if
anybody wants to
okay
so i type the slash
which opens up coda affordances like
inserting any number of
things and then

inserting a table
and this will be
active inference
code
and so then we can start
go from the unstructured list to the
structured list
into the table
what language is it
is it a walk-through or is it something
for application and structure
that discussion around code
yeah thank you everybody who's um who's
joining we're
enacting the kind of epistemic niche for
active inference that we are
implicitly or explicitly
expecting and preferring so we might as
well
and and the organizing
we can also note was in edu and comms so
in two of our weekly active lab meetings
so there's a whole team and many people
contributed variously
to setting up this niche
and
set up the niche was all we did like
it's for us to actually co-create in our
learning
but
this was a
participatory project just like
everything in actin flap is so if
anybody is like wanting to learn more
about participating in other active lab
activities
on the top page
you can

learn more about becoming a participant
in academic lab as well so there's like
a ton of cool projects to get involved
in

including active block for instance a
lot of in the ontology educational
materials

future cohorts of the textbook group
and so on so there'll be a ton to do
all right

so that concludes the onboarding session

i'm going to stop the recording unless
anyone has any final thoughts

okay i'm gonna stop the recording